



WORKSHOP MATERIALS

Writing Standard Operating Procedures

What we learned building a company-wide launch and operations guide

Richard Rabil

What are the guides?

- Central, authoritative documentation on the company wiki for how delivery teams launch and operate a product for clients.
- Built from templates: guide landing page, phase page, POP page, SOP page, reference page.
- Built from content types: overviews, roles, dependencies, tasks.
- Grounded in extensive research and design.

EXAMPLE — SOLSTICE DOCS

[solsticedocs.internal/launch-operations](#)

Launch and Operations Guides — Home

Internal resource: do not distribute to clients.

Overview

- Centralized info on how we launch and operate client products.

Getting Started

- Launch and Operations Process
- Roles and Responsibilities
- Documentation Guide

[Overview](#)
[Getting Started](#)
[Standard Guide](#)
[Product-Specific Guides](#)
[See Also](#)

Determine your guide structure

Standard structure

- Guide landing page
- Phase
- POP
- SOP, SOP, SOP
- POP
- SOP, SOP
- Reference
- Phase ...

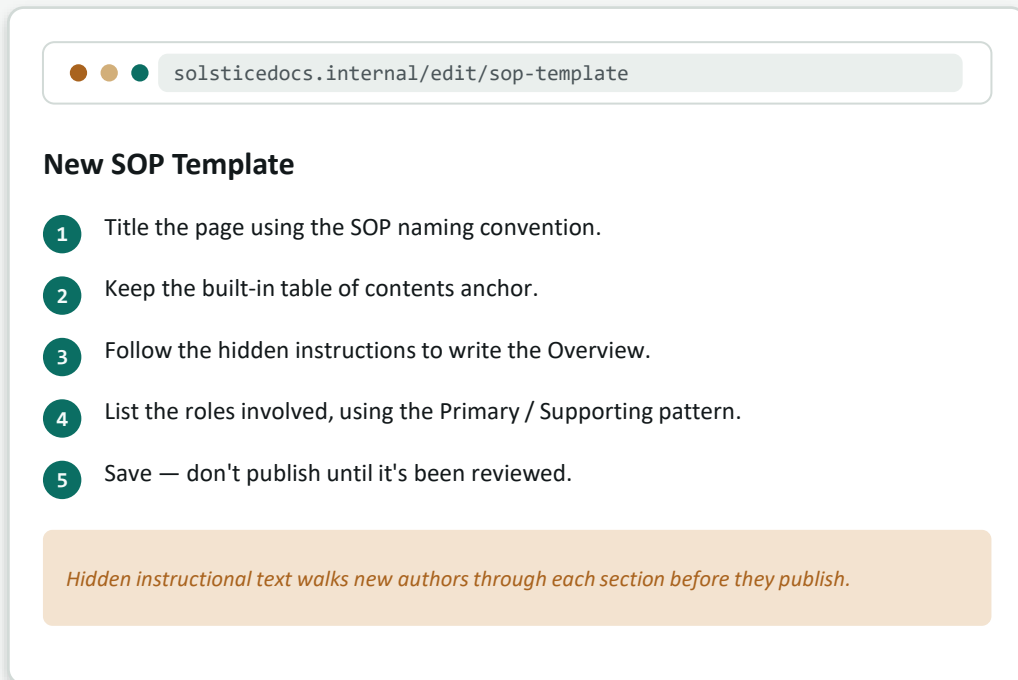
Custom structure

- Guide landing page
- SOP, SOP, SOP, SOP, SOP
- Reference
- ...

Create your templates

- What worked for us — let's look at our structure in practice.
- Create a test guide landing page.
- Create a test phase landing page.
- Create a test POP landing page.
- Create a test SOP page.

EXAMPLE — TEMPLATE EDITOR



The screenshot shows a web browser window with the address bar displaying `solsticedocs.internal/edit/sop-template`. Below the browser window, the heading **New SOP Template** is followed by a numbered list of five instructions. The instructions are: 1. Title the page using the SOP naming convention. 2. Keep the built-in table of contents anchor. 3. Follow the hidden instructions to write the Overview. 4. List the roles involved, using the Primary / Supporting pattern. 5. Save — don't publish until it's been reviewed. At the bottom of the editor, there is a light orange box containing the text: *Hidden instructional text walks new authors through each section before they publish.*

`solsticedocs.internal/edit/sop-template`

New SOP Template

- 1 Title the page using the SOP naming convention.
- 2 Keep the built-in table of contents anchor.
- 3 Follow the hidden instructions to write the Overview.
- 4 List the roles involved, using the Primary / Supporting pattern.
- 5 Save — don't publish until it's been reviewed.

Hidden instructional text walks new authors through each section before they publish.

BEST PRACTICE

Get buy-in

- Get buy-in on your approach — quarterly planning, a clear publishing process, and clear roles.
- Define a clear scope for each quarter.
- Get support not just from managers, but subject-matter experts who can be champions.

METRICS TO TRACK

Number of SOPs published, pages archived, tickets with linked SOPs, number of contributors.

Define roles and workflows

- Identify what each team is responsible for.
- Give everyone the tools to self-serve.

Help users self-serve

- Beyond templates, maintain a documentation guide.
- Define the minimum criteria for certifying a page.
- Provide user training.
- Provide opportunities for 1:1 assistance — for example, office hours and working sessions with teams.

Simplify ongoing maintenance

- Maintain a documentation guide.
- Keep your templates simple and up to date.
- Maintain a content-reuse and image library.
- Have a clear content archival process.



Q&A

Writing Standard Operating Procedures — Richard Rabil

rrabil.github.io/portfolio